pix2pix Style Transfer

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For this assignment, I experimented with different input sketches/ images and pre-trained models using pix2pix style transfer to create my work.

I created simple elements representing my dream of living in a farm surrounded by animals and flowers. However, the result was not as aesthetically pleasing as I expected.

I think this happened because my input sketches and the training data was too mismatched in terms of the shape, textures and vibes. If the model used lacked sufficient examples of certain object categories (e.g. house or snail), it struggled to successfully transfer the style. Since pix2pix models rely on edges and structure alignment, my sketches were too abstract or did not match the expected structure. Therefore, I learnt that the effectiveness of each model was highly dependent on how closely my input drawing matched the data the model was trained on.

Secondly, I also noticed that some models like the Pikachu transferred colour more effectively. The yellow and brown colours appeared in the fence and butterflies very clearly but the drawings like the house, flower, and snail turned out dull, black-and-white. These suggest that datasets with bright colour palettes can influence the output quality and vibrancy.

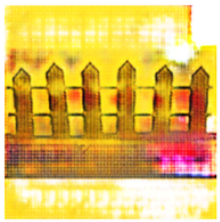
Moving forward, I hope to explore making my own custom models. By curating a dataset that matches my style and subjects, I can gain greater control over the outputs and achieve more consistent and personalised results. This would also deepen my understanding of how training data can influence the final generated images.

sketch of a farmhouse

Model used: facade

turned out like a haunted house instead :(

Image of a farm fence



Model used: Pikachu

More colours appeared and structure was preserved. But it's too yellow

Sketch of snail

Model used: handbag

Form is recognisable but appeared too desaturated

Sketch of flower

Model used: human

Desaturated and uneven black spaces too

Sketch of butterflies

Model used: Pikachu

Colours are present but appear uneven and patchy